

```

case Result of
atomic -> {ok, Body} = webapp_dtl:render([the_list,
SendList]);
_ -> {ok, Body} = webapp_dtl:render([the_list, []])
end,
% webmachine expects a tuple
{Body, ReqData, Context}.

```

The resource module needs at least two functions by default—*init* and *to_html*. The *init* function is used to specify the context needed for this resource. Webmachine passes it, as is, to various functions.

The default name of the function for the GET request is *to_html*. In case the key field is empty or not defined, the function does nothing; otherwise, it inserts the key/value pair in a table. It then queries the table for all records that have the desired value and displays the result in a template.

The *templates/webapp.dtl* template is similar to the one explained in the previous article:

```

<html>
<body>
<form method="GET">
<p>Key: <input type="text" name="key">
Value: <input type="text" name="value"></p>
<p> Search for Value" <input type="text" name="search_
for"></p>
<input type="submit">
</form>
{% for table,key,value in the_list %}
<p> {{ key }} Value {{ value }} </p>
{% endfor %}
</body>
</html>

```

For completeness, the code in *src/db.erl* for storing and querying data from *mnesia* is as follows:

```

-module(db).
-export([init/0,insert_key/2,read_data/1,match_value/1]).

```

```

-record(store,{key,value}).
init() ->
mnesia:create_table(store,
[[attributes,record_info(fields,
store]])).
insert_key(K,V) ->
F=fun() -> mnesia:write(#store{key=K,value=V})
end,
mnesia:transaction(F).
match_value(Val) ->
Pattern = #store{ _ = '_', value=Val},
F = fun() ->
mnesia:match_object(Pattern)
end,
mnesia:transaction(F).

```

Finally, *mnesia* needs to be started. Add the following lines at the beginning of the *start* function in *src/webmachine_demo.erl*:

```

application:set_env(mnesia,dir,"db"),
mnesia:create_schema([node()]),
ensure_started(mnesia),
db:init(),

```

Compile and run *start.sh*. Now browse *http://localhost:8000/key* and explore the form.

Getting used to Erlang is not difficult. Functional programming is fun. 

References

- [1] <https://github.com/basho/webmachine/wiki>
- [2] http://www.erlang.org/doc/apps/mnesia/Mnesia_chap2.html
- [3] http://en.wikiversity.org/wiki/Web_Development_with_Webmachine_for_Erlang

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com>, <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, and reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

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